

BookLore 3.0

Familiarization Guide

A friendly, complete walkthrough of everything BookLore can do — written for users of all experience levels.

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Audience: New and non-technical users

This guide should be updated whenever features are added, changed, or removed.

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1. What Is BookLore?

BookLore is a **self-hosted digital library** — a personal application you run on your own computer or server to organize, read, and manage your book and comic collection. Think of it as your own private digital bookshelf accessible from any web browser on any device.

Supported Formats

Format	Description
PDF	Standard document files (books, manuals, magazines)
EPUB	Common e-book format used by most e-readers
CBZ / CBR	Comic book archives (zipped or RAR-compressed image collections)
Audiobooks	Audio files organized in folders (MP3, M4A, etc.)
Physical Books	Catalog entries for physical books you own (no digital file required)

What You Can Do

- Store and organize thousands of books across multiple libraries
- Read books, comics, and listen to audiobooks directly in your browser
- Track your reading progress across devices
- Highlight text, add bookmarks, and write notes
- Search and filter your entire collection
- Fetch book information (metadata) from the internet automatically
- Share your catalog with e-readers via OPDS feeds
- Manage multiple users with different access levels
- Use AI to detect comic panels for panel-by-panel reading

2. Getting Started — First-Time Setup

When you open BookLore for the very first time, you will see the **Setup Wizard**.

What You Do

1. **Create your admin account** — Choose a username and strong password. This is the main administrator account.

2. **Set up your first library** — Point BookLore to the folder on disk where your books are stored (for example, `/books`).
3. **Configure authentication** — Choose how users will log in (local password, OIDC, or forward auth).

What You Can't Do

- You cannot skip creating the admin account — it is required.
- You cannot change the admin username later through the normal interface.
- You cannot undo the first-time setup once completed — but you can change all settings afterward.

Be Careful: Choose a strong password. Anyone who knows this password has full control over BookLore. If you lose the admin password and have no other login method configured, recovery requires direct database access.

3. The Dashboard — Your Home Screen

The Dashboard is the first screen you see after logging in. It provides a quick overview of your library.

What You Can Do

- See library statistics at a glance (total books, reading status, etc.)
- Access recently added books, continue-reading shortcuts, and other quick-start scrollers from one screen
- Configure dashboard sections from **Dashboard Settings** on the left sidebar's **Dashboard** row, including up to 20 scrollers such as **Continue Reading**, **Continue Listening**, **Recently Added**, **Discover Something New**, **Magic Shelf**, and **Currently Reading**
- Set each scroller's library filter, width, and item count, then lock the layout if you want to prevent accidental drag reordering
- Add books to the optional **Currently Reading** panel from a book's **More Actions** → **Currently Reading** menu item
- Refresh the page on mobile without the dashboard cards stretching into tall broken columns; the dashboard now recalculates its grid width after the page finishes loading
- Jump to any section using the sidebar navigation

What You Can't Do

- Place dashboard panels at arbitrary pixel positions outside the grid system

4. Navigating the Interface

BookLore uses a **sidebar + main content** layout.

Left Sidebar

Item	What It Does
Dashboard	Returns to the home screen
All Books	Shows every book across all your libraries
Physical Books	Shows your physical placeholders grouped by library, like a shelf overview for books you own off-screen
Libraries	Expandable list — click a library to see only its books
Shelves	Your custom collections
Not Shelfed	Books not assigned to any shelf
Series	Browse books grouped by series
Authors	Browse books by author
Magic Shelves	Your smart filtered collections
User Guide (bottom)	Open the familiarization guide PDF from the footer link
Settings (bottom)	Application configuration
Language (bottom)	Switch the interface language

What You Can Do

- **Resize sidebars** — Drag the edge of either sidebar to make it wider or narrower
- **Reorder sidebar items** — Select **Re-order** next to the sidebar show/hide control, then drag headings and rows with your mouse or touch; select **Re-order** again when you are finished

- **Collapse sections** — Click section headers to expand or collapse groups
- **Hide or show sidebar headings per user** — Heading visibility is now saved with your account, so the same layout follows you across sessions
- **Choose which HOME shortcuts appear** — Use the sidebar show/hide controls to decide whether entries like Dashboard, All Books, Physical Books, Series, Authors, and Notebook appear under HOME for your account
- **Keep Media Type labels and ordering per user** — Custom media types, recent choices, and the Media Type sidebar order now follow your account instead of staying in one browser only
- **Open the User Guide from the footer PDF button** — Use the footer PDF link to open the guide directly; if you want it to behave like a normal imported PDF in the built-in reader, copy it into a library or into BookDrop and import it like any other PDF
- **Open the folder panel while browsing books** — Use the folder button in **All Books** or a library view to browse by real library directories
- **Toggle browser fullscreen from the topbar** — Add or keep the fullscreen button in your toolbar, or use the same action from the mobile topbar menu when you want the interface to take over the whole screen

Good to Know: Switching between sidebar views does *not* reload your book grid from scratch — BookLore remembers what was on screen, so navigation is fast.

5. Libraries — Organizing Your Collection

A **Library** is a connection between BookLore and a folder on your computer or server where book files are stored.

What You Can Do

- **Create multiple libraries** — For example, one for “Fiction,” one for “Comics,” one for “Audiobooks”
- **Scan for new files** — Tell BookLore to look for files that are not already known in a library
- **Reconcile libraries** — Force BookLore to compare a library against disk and update library records to match
- **Open Library Maintenance** — Run high-impact library-wide actions from a dedicated maintenance dialog instead of mixing them with routine work
- **Open Library Settings and Manage Directories separately** — Routine library settings now live in **Library Settings**, while library path changes live in **Manage Directories**

- **See which directories are already imported while managing directories** — The **Manage Directories** list marks directories already in the library and now also labels parent rows when only imported subdirectories live underneath them, so you can tell imported paths from new additions at a glance
- **Choose whether new directories should scan immediately** — **Save** updates directory membership only, while **Save & Scan New Directories** imports only from the newly added paths
- **Save library changes without an automatic reconcile** — Editing settings or adding directories no longer silently triggers a full reconcile afterward
- **Move between library settings, directories, and maintenance from inside the dialogs** — The library-management dialogs now link to one another so you can stay in one workflow instead of backing out to the menu each time
- **Use a dedicated safe path before reconcile** — The maintenance dialog now points routine discovery work back to **Scan for New Files** and requires an explicit acknowledgement before **Reconcile Library** can run
- **Use a roomier mobile directory picker** — On phones and other compact screens, the directory picker now fits the dialog width correctly without slight sideways overflow, keeps search and selection controls in compact rows, and leaves more vertical space for the actual folder list
- **Use the mobile sidebar grab handles** — The left and right sidebar width bars now stay visibly available on touch devices as always-on touch handles so you can see where to grab, drag horizontally to resize, and drag vertically to help scroll long side panels
- **Use the phone back gesture to close the active mobile panel or popup first** — On mobile, the first back gesture now dismisses the topmost open surface (for example filter sidebars, topbar popovers, book preview viewers, and reader overlays) before BookLore navigates away underneath it
- **See preparation feedback for large imports** — When creating a library with many files, the dialog now shows an in-between working state before the full progress overlay appears
- **Check library health** — Verify the folder is accessible and working
- **Delete libraries** — Remove a library from BookLore without deleting the original source files on disk
- **Restrict library access** — Control which users can see which libraries

Good to Know: The normal library menu keeps **Library Settings**, **Manage Directories**, and **Library Maintenance** grouped together near the bottom, above **Delete Library**, and the dialogs now cross-link to one another so you can move between them without reopening the menu. Use **Library Settings** for naming, icon, and scan behavior. Use **Manage Directories** when you intentionally want to add or remove library paths. Inside **Manage Directories**, **Save** updates paths only, while **Save & Scan New Directories**

imports only from newly added directories. **Scan for New Files** remains the library-wide safe additive discovery action, while **Reconcile Library** and library-wide sidecar import/export/backup tools stay inside **Library Maintenance**, where reconcile now requires an explicit acknowledgement before it can run. Scheduled library scans now follow that same additive new-file-only behavior. Changing directory-tag rules no longer silently retags existing books during a settings save, and additive scans only queue follow-up directory tagging for the books they just imported.

What You Can't Do

- Assign the same folder to two different libraries (each folder should belong to one library)
- Manage files on remote cloud services directly — BookLore reads from local or network-mounted folders

Be Careful:

- **Deleting a library removes the catalog entry, not the source files on disk.** If you want to delete real book files, that happens through book-file deletion flows, not library removal.
- **Moving or renaming book files outside of BookLore** will cause them to appear missing. Always let BookLore manage file movements.
- **Use Reconcile Library intentionally.** It is not the same as a safe new-file scan and may change existing library records to match disk.
- **If your book folder is on a network drive,** set `DISK_TYPE=NETWORK` in your environment configuration for better compatibility. Automatic metadata writes stay disabled there, but you can still run manual sidecar backups when you want a portable metadata snapshot.

6. Books — Adding, Browsing, and Managing

Browsing Books

- **All Books** — View every book in your collection, displayed as a grid of cover images
- **Untitled cards fall back to the filename** — If a book has no stored metadata title yet, BookLore shows the asset filename on the card so the item remains identifiable
- **Adjust browser display settings from the cog menu** — Use the display-settings popover to change cover text rows, overlays, and whether subtitles appear after the main title as **Title : Subtitle**; that subtitle format now stays consistent across the main

grid, table titles, cover-tooltips, and the cover preview panel once the browser list loads metadata subtitles from the API

- **Library switching can feel faster after the first hover** — When you pause on a library in the sidebar, BookLore quietly warms a small set of that library’s thumbnails so the next switch shows fewer blank covers while images stream in
- **Click any book cover** to open its detail page with full information
- **Close book details cleanly** — The back arrow in Book Details returns you to the page you opened from instead of walking backward through every detail view
- **Right-click a book cover** (or long-press on mobile) for quick actions

Directory Explorer

BookLore includes a **folder explorer panel** for book browsing. It lets you filter the current view by the actual folders inside your libraries instead of relying only on shelves or metadata filters.

Action	What It Does
Open the folder panel	Click the folder button while viewing All Books or a specific library
Expand a folder branch	Click the + or – toggle next to a top-level folder
Select a top-level folder	Click the folder row itself to show only books stored directly in that root folder, with root folders and nested folders listed in alphabetical order and the book list switching to filename-based browsing
Select a subfolder	Click a nested folder to show books inside that folder and its child folders; while a directory filter is active, BookLore shows filenames in the main list and keeps the active sort pinned to filename order instead of metadata title order, while still respecting the current filename sort direction
Clear a folder filter	Click the selected folder again, use the reset button beside the folder toggle, use the normal filter clear action, or click the active library or shelf in the left sidebar to return to that collection’s normal view
Browse across libraries	In All Books , the panel shows each library root so you can filter across multiple libraries from one screen

What You Can Do

Action	How
View book details	Click the book cover
Read a book	Click “Read” on the detail page or double-click the cover
Add to a shelf	Right-click → Add to Shelf, or use the book detail page
Remove from shelf	Right-click → Remove from Shelf
Change reading status	Set to: Not Started, Reading, Completed, or Abandoned
Pin a book to Currently Reading	Use More Actions → Currently Reading to add or remove a book from the optional dashboard panel
Rate a book	Give it 1–5 stars on the detail page
Edit metadata	Update title, author, description, cover, etc.
Delete a book	Right-click → Delete (with optional disk deletion)
Delete multiple books	Select books (checkbox mode) then delete in bulk
Add a physical book	Create a catalog entry for a book you own physically in a chosen library directory, while keeping it available for metadata, covers, shelves, and filters
Assign file type	Choose how to open a file (e.g., read a PDF as an e-book instead)

Good to Know: Physical books stay visible as normal library assets after you create them. You can find them from **Physical Books** under HOME and from normal library and shelf views without creating a synthetic custom media type. The **Add Physical Book** dialog can now fetch metadata from ISBN correctly before you save, so title, author, and cover details can be filled in from the lookup result instead of being typed manually every time. BookLore also blocks creating a second matching physical placeholder in the same library directory when it already finds the same physical ISBN or the same title/author placeholder there. Physical placeholders now also write a small directory sidecar in their chosen library folder, so a later rebuild or refresh can recreate them from disk-backed metadata instead of losing them, while skipping sidecar re-import if the library already contains the matching active book.

Physical Shelf View: The **Physical Books** HOME page now draws a shelf rail for each visual row inside a library section, so larger collections keep the shelf effect as the grid wraps onto additional rows instead of only showing one shelf bar at the bottom.

Backup Friendly: The **Sidecar** tools for a physical placeholder now target its library directory instead of requiring a digital book file. This gives you a portable metadata backup for physical entries and lets library-wide sidecar exports include physical books too.

What You Can't Do

- Directly edit the book file contents (BookLore is a reader and organizer, not an editor)
- Upload books from this screen (use BookDrop for that — see Section 7)
- Move or rename folders from the directory panel (it is a browser/filtering tool, not a file manager)

Be Careful:

- **Deleting a book with “delete from disk” enabled is permanent.** The file is gone. There is no recycle bin.
- **When Allow File Deletion is turned off, BookLore hides the “Delete from Disk” choice.** You can still use **Remove from Library** to hide the catalog entry while leaving the file on disk, and routine scans/watchers should not bring that removed book back on their own.
- **Bulk deleting books** is powerful — double-check your selection before confirming.
- **If you delete the only readable format from a normal digital book,** BookLore now removes that empty catalog shell instead of leaving behind a metadata-only entry. If you want a deliberate metadata-only placeholder, create a **Physical Book** instead.

7. BookDrop — Importing New Books

BookDrop is a **watch folder** — a special folder where you drop new book files, and BookLore will detect and import them.

How It Works

1. **Place files** in the BookDrop folder (usually mapped to `./bookdrop` in Docker)
2. **BookLore detects** the new files automatically (or you can click “Rescan”)
3. **Go to the BookDrop page** in BookLore to see pending files

4. **Review and edit** — Adjust metadata, assign to a library, set the destination path

5. **Finalize** — Click to import the files into your library

What You Can Do

Action	Description
Rescan	Manually trigger a scan of the BookDrop folder
Preview files	See file details before importing
Edit metadata	Change title, author, cover, etc. before import
Bulk edit	Update metadata for multiple files at once
Pattern extraction	Automatically parse filenames to extract title, author, series, etc.
Choose destination	Pick which library and folder path to import into
Discard files	Skip files you don't want to import
Finalize import	Move files from BookDrop into your library
Watch follow-up directory tagging	If the destination library uses directory-based tags, a separate background task continues after import and shows live progress plus time remaining in the top bar and Task Management

What You Can't Do

- Import files directly from a URL or the internet — you must first download them to the BookDrop folder
- Import unsupported file formats (stick to PDF, EPUB, CBZ, CBR, and audio formats)

Be Careful:

- **Files are moved, not copied, during import.** After finalization, the original file in BookDrop is removed.
- **Pattern extraction is only as good as your filename.** If filenames are messy, you may need to edit metadata manually.
- **Don't put files into BookDrop while a scan is actively running.** Wait for the scan to complete first, then add files and rescan.
- **Import complete may not mean directory tags are finished.** When directory tagging is enabled, BookLore now treats tagging as a separate background phase, so wait for the **Directory Tags** task to finish before assuming all folder-based tags are in place.

8. Shelves — Custom Collections

Shelves are like playlists for your books. You can create as many as you want and assign any book to one or more shelves.

What You Can Do

Action	Description
Create a shelf	Give it a name and optionally an icon
Add books	Assign books to a shelf from the book detail page or right-click menu
Remove books	Take books off a shelf without deleting them
Rename a shelf	Change its name anytime
Delete a shelf	Remove the shelf (books are not deleted)
Browse a shelf	Click a shelf in the sidebar to see only its books
Make a shelf public	Admins can make shelves visible to all users
Kobo device shelf	Special shelf type that syncs to connected Kobo e-readers

Tip: Click **Not Shelfed** in the sidebar to see every book not assigned to any shelf — useful for organizing new additions.

What You Can't Do

- Nest shelves inside other shelves (shelves are flat, not hierarchical)

Good to Know: Deleting a shelf does *NOT* delete its books. The books remain in your library — only the shelf grouping is removed.

9. Magic Shelves — Smart Filtered Collections

Magic Shelves are **automatic collections** that populate themselves based on rules you define. They update automatically as your library changes.

Examples

- “Books I Haven’t Read Yet” (filter: reading status = Not Started)

- “5-Star Books” (filter: rating = 5)
- “All Comics” (filter: media type = Comic)
- “Books by Stephen King” (filter: author = Stephen King)
- “Added This Month” (filter: date added = last 30 days)

What You Can Do

- Create magic shelves with custom filter rules
- Combine multiple filters (e.g., “Unread comics rated 4+ stars”)
- Edit filter rules anytime — the shelf updates automatically
- Make them public (admin only) — share with all users
- Delete magic shelves when no longer needed

What You Can’t Do

- Manually add or remove specific books from a magic shelf — membership is determined entirely by the filter rules

Be Careful: A magic shelf with very broad rules may include thousands of books, which can slow down loading.

10. Reading Books

BookLore includes built-in readers for every supported format. Each reader is tailored to its format.

Good to Know: On mobile, the system back gesture or back button now closes whichever reader panel, menu, or dialog is currently open (such as sidebars, quick settings, overflow menus, and preview dialogs) before leaving the reader screen.

a) PDF Reader

Opens PDF files (books, manuals, documents) in a dedicated viewer.

Feature	Description
Page navigation	Go to any page, use forward/back arrows, or type a page number
Table of contents	Jump to chapters using the built-in outline (if the PDF has one)
Page thumbnails	See small previews of all pages for quick navigation
Zoom	Zoom in and out for easier reading
Bookmarks	Save your place with labeled bookmarks
Highlights	Select text and highlight it in different colors
Annotations	Add notes to highlighted sections
Reading progress	Automatically saved — pick up where you left off

What You Can't Do: Edit PDF text, fill in forms, or print directly from BookLore (use your browser's print function).

Be Careful: Very large PDFs (hundreds of megabytes) may load slowly. Some complex PDFs with unusual formatting may not render perfectly.

b) E-Book (EPUB) Reader

Opens EPUB e-book files with a clean, comfortable reading experience.

Feature	Description
Chapter navigation	Use the table of contents to jump between chapters
Adjust font size	Make text larger or smaller for comfortable reading
Adjust line spacing	Increase or decrease space between lines
Bookmarks	Save your place
Highlights	Select text and highlight in colors
Annotations	Write notes attached to highlighted text
Reading progress	Automatically tracked
Custom fonts	Upload and use your preferred fonts (see Settings)

What You Can't Do: Change the book's text or view DRM-protected (copy-protected) files.

Be Careful: BookLore only supports DRM-free e-books. DRM-locked files will not open.

c) Comic (CBX) Reader

Opens CBZ and CBR comic book files with page and panel navigation.

Feature	Description
Page navigation	Flip through comic pages
Page list	Jump to any page by number
Webtoon mode	Enable continuous vertical scrolling for web comics
AI panel detection	Navigate panel-by-panel within each page (requires AI feature)
Bookmarks	Mark favorite pages
Reading progress	Automatically tracked

What You Can't Do: Annotate or highlight on comic pages (image-based format), or edit/reorder pages.

Be Careful: CBR files (RAR format) may extract more slowly than CBZ files (ZIP format). Very high-resolution scans can use significant memory.

Metadata note: If your deployment enables **Save to Original File** for CBR comics, mounting a compatible Linux `rar` binary into the BookLore container lets metadata writes stay in the original `.cbr`. Without that binary, BookLore may fall back to converting the file to `.cbz`, which takes longer.

d) Audiobook Player

Plays audiobooks — collections of audio files organized in a folder.

Feature	Description
Track listing	See all tracks/chapters in the audiobook
Play / Pause	Standard audio controls
Seek / Scrub	Jump forward or backward within a track
Chapter navigation	Skip between tracks/chapters
Duration display	See total and remaining time
Progress tracking	Automatically saves your listening position

What You Can't Do: Adjust playback speed natively (use browser extensions if needed).

Be Careful: Audiobooks must be organized as folders containing audio files. Make sure files are in common formats (MP3, M4A, OGG, etc.).

11. Bookmarks, Annotations, and the Notebook

Bookmarks

Simple position markers with an optional label. Use them to mark pages you want to return to.

- **Create:** While reading, click the bookmark icon at your current position
- **Label:** Give bookmarks descriptive names (e.g., "Important chapter")
- **Color coding:** Assign colors to categorize bookmarks
- **Navigate:** Click any bookmark to jump back to that spot
- **Delete:** Remove bookmarks when no longer needed

Annotations (Highlights and Notes)

Available in PDF and EPUB readers.

- **Highlight:** Select text → choose a highlight color
- **Underline / Strikethrough:** Additional marking styles
- **Add notes:** Attach written notes to any highlight
- **Edit:** Change colors, styles, or note text anytime
- **Delete:** Remove individual annotations

The Notebook

A centralized view of **all your annotations across every book**.

- See all highlights and notes in one place
- Filter by book, type, or date
- Search through your annotations
- Export all annotations for backup
- Quickly jump to the source book and location

Good to Know: Annotations are created while reading — you cannot create them from the Notebook view.

12. Reading Progress and Statistics

Reading Progress

- **Automatic saving** — Your position is saved every time you read
- **Resume reading** — Open a book and you're taken right back to where you left off
- **Reading status** — Set to: Not Started, Reading, Completed, or Abandoned
- **Sync across devices** — Read on your phone then your computer; progress stays in sync

Reading Statistics Page

Statistic	What It Shows
Books completed	Total count of finished books
Currently reading	Books you're in the middle of
Reading streaks	Consecutive days with reading activity
Time spent	Total time spent reading
Monthly / Yearly breakdown	Reading activity over time
Favorite authors	Most-read authors based on your habits

Library Statistics Page

A separate page showing collection-level statistics: total books by format, genre, author, series; books by reading status; collection growth over time; and most recent additions.

When AI panel data exists, the page also shows AI-scanned comic totals and stored AI panel-data size for the selected library.

13. Series and Authors

Series

Books can be grouped into series (e.g., “Harry Potter,” “The Walking Dead”).

- **Browse by series** — Click “Series” in the sidebar
- **View all books in a series** — Click a series name to see its books in order
- Series are auto-detected from metadata

What You Can’t Do: Manually create a series from scratch (series come from book metadata) or reorder books within a series.

Authors

- **Browse all authors** — Alphabetical listing with book counts
- **View author details** — Biography, photo, and all their books
- **Edit author information** — Update name, bio, description, photo
- **Upload author photos** — Add images for authors who don’t have one

Tip: Use consistent author names in book metadata to avoid duplicate author entries (e.g., always “J.K. Rowling,” not sometimes “Rowling, J.K.”).

14. Metadata — Book Information

Metadata is all the information about a book: title, author, description, cover image, publication date, genre, ISBN, and more.

Fetching Metadata from the Internet

Action	Description
Fetch metadata	Search online providers by title, author, or ISBN
Use provider page URLs	Paste a provider page URL in metadata search (for example a ComicVine issue or volume page) to bias the match, resolve that item directly when supported, and for ComicVine volumes optionally enter an issue number or issue range (for example 46 or 43-171) to auto-resolve those issue pages
Navigate selected books while searching	When editing multiple books, use the previous/next controls from the selected-result detail view to move through the group; BookLore returns to that book's search results context before switching so you can continue review without losing place
Preview results	See what information was found before applying
Apply selectively	Choose which fields to update
Replace all	Overwrite all metadata with fetched information
Merge	Keep your edits and fill in only the missing fields
Fetch covers	Download book cover images
Fetch author info	Download author biographies and photos

Metadata Review Queue

- The fetched-proposal dialog is now titled **Metadata Review**
- In the Search Metadata detail comparison view, use the always-visible top control rail < and << buttons to copy missing fields or copy all fetched fields into the editable column
- Use **Skip** to move the current proposal to the end of the current review queue and jump straight to the next proposal
- Use the orange **Copy All, Save & Next** action in the top comparison header to run the common review routine in one step
- **Accept & Save** now waits for the metadata save itself to finish before the proposal is marked accepted, so the review queue and saved data stay in sync
- Use **Tag & Next** to add the **Metadata Follow-Up Req** tag to the current asset and advance without accepting the fetched proposal

- Use **Discard** from the topbar metadata-progress widget when you want to abandon the current review task; the matching task/proposals are now cleared and the live topbar notification is removed immediately
- In Search Metadata detail mode, **Lock All**, **Unlock All**, and **Save Changes** stay pinned in the top control rail so they remain reachable while scrolling
- **Finish & Close** now clears the matching topbar notification/task state when the review session is complete

Editing Metadata Manually

- Edit title, author, description, and all other fields by hand
- Upload a custom cover image
- Add or change genres, categories, and moods
- Set or update ISBN, publication date, and language
- Restore an empty title from the primary filename with a dedicated metadata-editor button
- Delete all editable metadata directly beside the fetch actions when you want to clear a book and immediately refetch it
- Delete all editable metadata for a single book from the metadata editor when you want to start over cleanly
- Create custom media types (Magazines, Textbooks, etc.)

Be Careful:

- **“Replace All” overwrites everything**, including any manual edits you’ve made. Use “Merge” if you want to keep your changes.
- **Fetches cover images may not match your edition.** Review the cover before applying.
- **ISBN lookup is the most reliable** way to get accurate metadata. Use it when available.
- You cannot undo a metadata overwrite once applied.

15. Metadata Manager — Bulk Editing

The Metadata Manager lets you edit metadata for many books at once.

What You Can Do

- Select multiple books for batch metadata operations
- Apply the same genre, category, or mood to many books at once

- Bulk-update reading status or media type
- Bulk-fetch metadata for selected books, with better recovery when a provider's first match fails but later candidates still contain usable metadata
- Limit a custom metadata fetch to all selected books, only books that have never been fetched, or only books whose last successful metadata fetch is older than a chosen age window
- Use the custom metadata fetch ComicVine fields (source URL plus issue number or issue range like 43-171) to sequence exact ComicVine issue lookups across selected books, including manual-review workflows
- Restore titles for selected books from each book's own primary filename from the bulk metadata actions menu when those books still have blank, unlocked titles
- Delete all metadata for selected books from the bulk selection action bar

Be Careful: Bulk edits are immediate and cannot be reversed. Double-check your selection and changes before applying. Start with small batches to verify results. Bulk metadata deletion clears the selected books' metadata in one step, but BookLore now keeps a filename-derived title when one is available so you can search again immediately.

Good to Know: If one metadata source fails to return a usable first match during a bulk custom scan, BookLore now falls back more gracefully instead of abandoning that whole book as aggressively. For providers that temporarily throttle large jobs, BookLore now retries the throttled request itself after the cooldown window, keeps the metadata task visible as still running, restores the metadata-fetch topbar pill from the active task state after refreshes or reconnects, lets you start a new custom fetch against only books that have never been fetched or books whose last successful metadata fetch is older than a selected age window, marks zombie in-progress metadata tasks as resumable instead of leaving them hung forever after a stop or restart, offers resume actions for stopped metadata batches, shows a clearly paused topbar state with the reset ETA instead of a stale time-left snapshot, opens a simple fetched-versus-remaining asset log when you click the topbar metadata pill, lets metadata editors cancel those metadata jobs directly from the progress widget even without broader task-manager access, interrupts long ComicVine cooldown waits promptly when you cancel the job, shows a clear cancellation-requested state instead of falsely marking a task fully cancelled before it actually stops, removes stale finished metadata tasks that the backend no longer reports, avoids holding the database transaction open during long provider cooldown waits, and uses a lighter top-match lookup path for ComicVine batch scans so large runs are less likely to exhaust the hourly request budget mid-batch.

Custom Metadata Fetch Defaults: The advanced custom metadata fetch dialog now opens with **Merge Genres** off by default and **Manual Review** on by default, so a new batch starts in a safer review-first mode unless you intentionally change those toggles.

16. Search and Filtering

Global Search

Type in the search bar to find books across your entire collection by title, author name, description, or ISBN. The topbar search now pulls lightweight server results as you type, so it stays responsive even before a large browser view has finished warming up.

Filters

Filter	Options
Library	Show books from a specific library only
Directory / Folder	Show books from a selected top-level folder or subfolder in the directory explorer
Shelf	Show books on a specific shelf
Reading status	Not Started, Reading, Completed, Abandoned
Media type	E-book, PDF, Comic, Audiobook, Physical, Custom types
Author	Filter by specific author
Series	Filter by series
Genre / Category	Filter by genre or category tag
Rating	Filter by your personal star rating
Language	Filter by book language

What You Can Do

- Combine multiple filters (e.g., “Unread comics in my Comics library”)
- Filter by real storage folders from the directory explorer while keeping your other filters active

- Return from a folder-scoped browse by using the reset button beside the folder toggle or by clicking the same library or shelf again in the left sidebar, either of which clears that directory selection and restores the collection's normal title-aware view
- Use **Physical Books** under HOME to jump straight to physical placeholders, then mix that view with other filters like library, shelf, and reading status as needed
- Hover the filter-mode buttons to see what each mode does: **AND** requires every selected filter to match, **OR** accepts any selected match, **NOT** hides matches, and **1** keeps only one active selection at a time
- Scroll the desktop filter sidebar as one continuous panel instead of fighting a second nested scrollbar inside long filter groups
- Keep the desktop filter panel anchored flush to the right edge of its sidebar while you scroll and expand filter groups
- Open **All Books**, a library, a shelf, or **Not Shelfed** and start browsing from the first paged results immediately instead of waiting for BookLore to preload the whole catalog in the background
- Switch between libraries and shelves, including cached views reopened from the left sidebar, without manually refreshing or toggling the filter sort to repopulate metadata-backed sidebar filters such as authors, tags, series, publishers, and languages
- Apply tag and other metadata edits without needing repeated browser refreshes before the right sidebar selections and facet counts catch up
- Use the **Date Added** and **Folder** sidebar filters to narrow or exclude books by when they were imported or which directory they reside in, under every filter mode (AND, OR, NOT, 1)
- Keep your filter sidebar visibility, filter sort mode, and expanded filter groups with your user account instead of one browser profile
- Clear all filters with one click

Good to Know: In **AND** mode, the tag and sidebar option lists now narrow themselves to combinations that can actually exist together. After you choose one tag, BookLore only offers additional tags that still leave at least one matching book in the current result set.

Mode Changes Reset Sidebar Selections: Switching between **AND**, **OR**, **NOT**, and **1** now clears the current sidebar filter selections first. This prevents an old selection set from being silently reinterpreted under a different mode.

Mode Changes Now Re-sync the Whole Browser: The filter-mode button is no longer allowed to get ahead of the actual book-list filtering logic. BookLore now clears the previous sidebar state first, then activates the new mode from one shared parent state so

the button, sidebar facets, and filtered book list stay in sync without repeated browser refreshes.

What Changed: After you already have sidebar selections active, switching to a different filter mode now updates the highlighted mode button immediately on the first click instead of waiting for a second click to make the new mode look selected.

Sidebar Selections Stay Honest: After tag or other metadata changes, the right sidebar now refreshes its backing book list immediately so deselected items do not linger until a second manual refresh. Selection highlights also treat equivalent numeric and text ids as the same choice, which prevents a filter row from looking stuck when the underlying value format changes.

Switching Filter Groups No Longer Collapses Prematurely: When you already have tags or other sidebar filters active, opening a different filter group now keeps that group open instead of flashing half-open and snapping shut because the accordion state now preserves single-panel header changes correctly.

Sidebar Counts Now Line Up Consistently: The right-edge count badges in each filter section now anchor to the same shared edge as the section chevrons with a tighter inset, so long filter names still truncate cleanly and the scrollbar no longer crowds the badge column.

Duplicate Review

BookLore's duplicate finder is now designed as a **scoped review tool**. Open it from a library menu, then choose whether to scan your **current filtered view**, the **current library**, or **all libraries**.

Sidcar Backup Coverage: Manual per-library sidcar backup now follows each book's real readable file even when a book also has non-book attachments, so EPUB, PDF, CBR, and CBZ titles are backed up alongside physical placeholders instead of only the physical entries appearing.

Backup Failure Reporting: If BookLore can see the books but cannot write into the library directory, the manual sidcar backup message now reports how many writes failed and shows the first filesystem error instead of only saying that zero books were backed up.

Good to Know: The duplicate review screen is intentionally non-destructive. It shows likely duplicate groups, highlights a suggested book to keep, lets you inspect another

candidate side-by-side, and can open book details or launch a reader for digital files without deleting or merging anything.

Why This Matters: Using the current filtered view lets you investigate duplicates only inside the slice you are already looking at, such as a single shelf, a search result, a folder, or a filtered library window, without scanning the rest of the collection.

Manual Resolution Plans: After reviewing a duplicate group, you can now mark your preferred book to keep, queue the group into a manual resolution list, and then copy or download that plan for follow-up. This gives you a safe handoff document without changing any book records.

Saved to Your Account: Your queued duplicate-resolution plan now follows your BookLore user account. If you close the dialog and come back later, BookLore can restore the saved scan scope and reapply the queued keep choices to matching duplicate groups after the next scan.

Saved Snapshot: Before you rescan, BookLore now shows the queued duplicate groups already stored on your account, including the preferred keep, the match reason, and the other candidates that were part of that saved plan.

Custom Matching Starts Empty: If you choose the **Custom** matching preset, BookLore now clears all matching signals first so you can build your own scan from a blank starting point instead of inheriting the previous preset.

What You Can't Do

- Search inside book contents (search only covers metadata)
- Save filter combinations as presets (use Magic Shelves instead)

17. AI Comic Panel Detection

An **optional** feature that uses artificial intelligence to detect individual panels on comic book pages, enabling panel-by-panel reading.

How to Use

1. Enable AI in **Settings** → **AI Panel Detection**
2. Wait for status to show "READY"

3. Open a comic in the reader
4. Click the AI button to scan the current book
5. Or use bulk scan from AI settings to process all comics at once

What You Can Do

- Scan individual comics or bulk scan entire libraries
- Delete panel data for specific comics
- View statistics on scanned comics, including saved scan counts and stored AI panel-data size
- Reload the AI model if it stops responding
- Watch batch AI scan progress from the topbar and let the completion pill clear itself shortly after the scan finishes instead of leaving a stale completed message behind

What You Can't Do

- Use panel detection on non-comic formats
- Guarantee 100% accurate panel detection — AI may occasionally miss or misidentify panels

Be Careful: AI processing uses significant CPU resources. Bulk scanning large collections may slow down your server. The AI container is optional — omit `COMPOSE_PROFILES=ai` from your environment to skip it entirely.

18. OPDS Feeds — E-Reader Integration

OPDS (Open Publication Distribution System) lets e-readers browse and download books directly from your BookLore library.

How to Set Up

1. Go to **Settings** → **OPDS**
2. Copy your personal OPDS feed URL
3. Enter the URL in your e-reader's OPDS catalog settings

What You Can Do

- Browse your library from any OPDS-compatible e-reader or app
- Download books directly to your e-reader

- Search your catalog from the e-reader's search function
- Access feeds by category: Libraries, Shelves, Magic Shelves, Series, Authors

What You Can't Do

- Stream audiobooks via OPDS (downloads only)
- Use OPDS to upload books to BookLore (download only)

Be Careful: Keep your OPDS token private. Anyone with the URL can access your library. If you change your token, all connected e-readers will need to be updated.

19. Kobo and KoReader Device Sync

BookLore can sync reading progress with **Kobo** and **KoReader** compatible devices.

What You Can Do

- Sync reading position between BookLore and your device
- Create a dedicated Kobo device shelf for content management
- Transfer books to your device and keep progress synchronized

What You Can't Do: Sync with Kindle devices directly (use OPDS or email-to-Kindle instead).

Be Careful: Device sync is experimental. Minor discrepancies in page positioning may occur between the web reader and physical device.

20. Email — Sending Books

How to Set Up

1. Go to **Settings** → **Email**
2. Configure your email provider (SMTP server, port, username, password)
3. Add recipient email addresses

What You Can Do

- Send individual books to configured email addresses
- Configure multiple recipients

- Use email templates for formatting

What You Can't Do

- Send books larger than your email provider's attachment limit (typically 25 MB)
- Send audiobooks via email (file sizes are too large)

Be Careful: Store your SMTP credentials securely. Large books may fail to send if they exceed your provider's size limit.

21. User Accounts and Permissions

User Roles

Role	Access Level
Admin	Full access to everything, including settings and user management
Regular User	Access to assigned libraries and personal features

Permissions (Configurable per User)

Permission	What It Allows
BookDrop Access	Upload and import books through BookDrop
Metadata Editing	Fetch and edit book metadata
Library Management	Create, modify, and delete libraries
Book Deletion	Delete books (optionally from disk)
Task Manager	View and run background tasks
View Audit Logs	Access the audit log

What Admins Can Do

- Create, edit, and delete user accounts
- Reset user passwords
- Assign permissions to each user
- Restrict users to specific libraries

- Make shelves and magic shelves public

What Regular Users Can Do

- Read books in their assigned libraries
- Create personal shelves and magic shelves
- Manage their own bookmarks, annotations, and reading progress
- Change their own password and profile

Be Careful:

- The **“Book Deletion”** permission allows permanent file deletion from disk. Only grant this to trusted users.
- **Library Management** permission allows creating and deleting libraries — grant carefully.

22. Authentication — Login Methods

BookLore supports three ways to log in:

Local Password

The default method — log in with your username and password. Simplest option for personal use. Passwords are stored securely (hashed). Sessions use JWT tokens that auto-refresh.

OIDC (OpenID Connect)

Use a third-party identity provider (like PocketID, Keycloak, or Authentik) for single sign-on.

1. Configure the OIDC provider (create a client for BookLore)
2. In BookLore Settings → Authentication, enter the Client ID, Issuer URI, and JWKS URL
3. Enable OIDC
4. Users can now log in with the “Login with [Provider]” button

Forward Auth (Reverse Proxy)

If you run BookLore behind a reverse proxy with an authentication layer (like Authelia), BookLore can trust the proxy’s authentication headers.

Be Careful:

- **If using Forward Auth, NEVER expose BookLore directly to the internet.** Always route through your authenticated reverse proxy.
- **OIDC requires correct URL configuration.** Incorrect Issuer URI or JWKS URL will prevent login entirely.
- **Test new authentication settings before disabling local login,** or you may lock yourself out.

23. Application Settings

Access settings via the gear icon at the bottom of the sidebar.

The main Settings page includes a compact icon-only left-arrow control in the top-right corner that returns you to the route you opened Settings from, instead of relying on generic browser-history back behavior.

Category	What You Can Configure
Reader Settings	Default font size, zoom, reading mode preferences
View Preferences	Book grid layout, cover preview panel, toolbar customization
User Management	Create/edit/delete users and their permissions
Email	SMTP server for sending books via email
File Naming Patterns	How imported files are named and organized
Metadata	Default metadata providers and API keys
Metadata Persistence	Write metadata into files, manage automatic sidecars, and run a manual per-library sidecar backup even when automatic sidecars are disabled
File Management	Control whether BookLore is allowed to delete real files from disk during book-file deletion actions
Library Metadata	Per-library metadata provider configuration
Authentication	OIDC and forward auth configuration
OPDS	E-reader feed configuration
Tasks	Background task scheduling (cron jobs)
Audit Logs	View user activity logs
AI Panel Detection	Enable/disable and manage comic panel AI
Global Preferences	Theme palette, custom primary/surface colors, language, timezone, settings backup

Good to Know: For CBR comics, embedded metadata writes are fastest when the BookLore container has access to a compatible Linux `rar` binary. Without it, BookLore may convert the archive to `.cbz` during a save-to-original-file operation.

Customizable Toolbar

- **Add or remove buttons** — Choose which actions appear in the toolbar
- **Reorder buttons** — Drag and drop to rearrange
- **Add separators** — Insert visual dividers between button groups

- **Keep a fullscreen toggle in the toolbar** — Show or hide the fullscreen action like any other topbar button, and place it where it fits your layout best

Theme Colors

- **Choose preset colors for the interface** — The theme configurator lets you pick the accent color and the surface palette independently
- **Use a color picker or paste a value** — Both color controls accept a native color picker or a typed/pasted color such as `#ff6600`
- **Reset one side without resetting the other** — Clear the custom primary or custom surface color independently if you want to go back to presets
- **Keep your theme with your account** — Theme selections are saved to your user settings so they return on later sign-ins

Be Careful:

- **Changing authentication settings can lock you out.** Test OIDC configuration before disabling local login.
- **Settings export/import includes sensitive data** (email credentials, API keys). Store exported files securely.
- **Allow File Deletion is a hard safety gate.** When it is off, BookLore hides the **Delete from Disk** action, removes catalog associations only, and should not delete physical files from disk.

Good to Know:

- **The File Management toggle also protects additional attached files.** When **Allow File Deletion** is disabled, deleting an attached file removes it from BookLore without overriding the global disk-deletion block.
- **Remove from Library is now a durable hide action.** When you remove a book without deleting its file, BookLore keeps the file on disk but suppresses automatic re-import during later scans and watcher events.
- **Automatic sidecars and manual sidecar backups are separate.** You can keep automatic sidecar writing turned off and still run **Back Up Sidecars per Library** from Metadata Persistence when you want an on-demand metadata backup.
- **The backup action is available in both LOCAL and NETWORK disk modes.** Network mode still blocks automatic rewrite and file reorganization, but the manual sidecar backup action remains available as an explicit exception.
- **Running the backup again refreshes existing backup sidecars.** BookLore rewrites the selected library's sidecar files with the current database metadata instead of requiring you to delete old backups first.

- **Manual sidecar backups now show a light grey topbar working pill while they run.** The message is intentionally simple because the backup call is usually brief, but it gives you immediate confirmation that the action started.

24. Background Tasks

BookLore can run jobs in the background to maintain and update your library.

Task	What It Does
Library Scan	Detect newly added book files
Reconcile Library	Compare a library against disk and update library records to match
Metadata Refresh	Re-fetch metadata from providers for existing books
Deleted Books Cleanup	Remove catalog entries for files that no longer exist on disk
Temp Metadata Cleanup	Clear old cached metadata from previous searches
BookDrop Scan	Check the BookDrop folder for new files
KEPUB Conversion	Convert book formats for e-reader compatibility

What You Can Do

- Run tasks manually — Start any task on demand
- Schedule tasks — Set up automatic timing
- Cancel running tasks
- View task history and results
- Use **Library Settings** to change library naming, icon, and scan options without touching directories
- Use **Manage Directories** to add or remove library paths with explicit directory-focused actions
- Use **Save & Scan New Directories** when you want BookLore to import only from the directories you just added instead of rescanning the entire library
- Use **Scan for New Files** for safe additive discovery without a full reconcile
- Expect the maintenance dialog to steer routine discovery back toward **Scan for New Files** and require an explicit acknowledgement before **Reconcile Library** runs

- Expect scheduled **Library Scan** jobs to use the same safe additive discovery path as the manual **Scan for New Files** action
- Use **Library Maintenance** when you intentionally want to reconcile a library or run library-wide sidecar rewrite/import tools
- Monitor long-running directory-tagging follow-up work after imports, including the live status message and estimated time remaining when enough progress has been measured; additive scans limit that follow-up to newly imported books, while manual reconcile can still tag the whole library
- Expect directory-tag rule changes to affect future imports only; BookLore does not silently retag every existing book when you save those settings

Be Careful:

- **Reconcile Library on a very large library** can take a long time and use significant resources.
- **Reconcile Library** may remove missing-file entries and purge disallowed formats; use **Scan for New Files** when you only want to import newly added content.
- **Metadata Refresh** makes network calls — running too frequently may cause rate limiting from providers.

25. Backup and Restore

Protecting your BookLore data requires backing up **two things**:

1. Application Settings (Database)

Quick Export (Settings Only)

1. Go to **Settings** → **Global Preferences** → **Settings Transfer**
2. Click **Export**
3. Save the downloaded JSON file

This exports libraries, users, shelves, metadata settings, and preferences.

Full Database Backup (Recommended)

For complete protection (including all book metadata, reading progress, annotations, and shelf assignments), use a database dump:

```
docker exec mariadb mariadb-dump \
  --single-transaction --quick --no-tablespaces \
```

```
-u root -p"YOUR_ROOT_PASSWORD" \  
booklore > booklore_backup.sql
```

2. Book Files and Data

What to Back Up	Folder
Book files	<code>./books/</code>
Covers, thumbnails, and images	<code>./data/</code>
BookDrop inbox	<code>./bookdrop/</code>

Be Careful:

- **Settings export does NOT include reading progress, annotations, or book files.** For full protection, do a database dump AND file backup.
- **Store backups in a separate location** from your BookLore server.
- **Test your backups periodically.** A backup you've never tested is a backup you can't trust.
- **The Settings → Backups → Sidecar view now keeps a recent run history for the selected library.** You can review up to the last 10 manual sidecar backup runs there, including attempted, exported, failed, and the user who triggered the run, instead of only seeing one overwritten "last backup" record.

26. Audit Logs

What Is Logged

- User logins and logouts
- Book operations (create, update, delete)
- Shelf changes
- Metadata updates
- Settings changes
- User management actions
- BookDrop operations

What You Can Do

- View the full audit log (admin only)

- Filter by user, action type, or date
- Track who made changes and when

What You Can't Do: Delete individual log entries (logs are append-only).

27. Tips and Best Practices

For New Users

1. **Start small.** Set up one library, add a few books, and explore before importing your entire collection.
2. **Use BookDrop** for importing rather than manually placing files.
3. **Fetch metadata early.** After importing, fetch metadata to fill in titles, authors, covers, and descriptions.
4. **Create shelves** to organize your favorites.
5. **Set your reading status** so you can track what you've read.

For Security

1. Use strong passwords for all accounts, especially the admin account.
2. Never expose BookLore directly to the internet without a reverse proxy and authentication.
3. Keep your OPDS token private.
4. Review user permissions carefully — only grant deletion rights to trusted users.
5. Back up regularly — both the database and your book files.

For Performance

1. Use CBZ over CBR when possible — ZIP extraction is faster than RAR.
2. Keep image sizes reasonable — extremely high-resolution scans use more memory.
3. Schedule background tasks during off-hours.
4. Don't scan libraries too frequently — once-daily scans are usually sufficient.

For Organization

1. Be consistent with author names to avoid duplicates.
2. Use genres and categories — they make filtering and Magic Shelves more useful.
3. Rate your books — ratings enable great Magic Shelf filters.
4. Use the Notebook to review all your annotations in one place.

28. Glossary

Term	Definition
Library	A connection between BookLore and a folder on your server where book files are stored
Shelf	A user-created collection for grouping books (like a playlist)
Magic Shelf	An automatically populated collection based on filter rules
BookDrop	A watch folder where you place new files for BookLore to import
Metadata	Information about a book — title, author, description, cover, ISBN, etc.
OPDS	A standard protocol that lets e-readers browse and download from your library
OIDC	OpenID Connect — a single sign-on standard for logging in via a third-party provider
Forward Auth	A method where a reverse proxy handles authentication before requests reach BookLore
CBZ / CBR	Comic book archive formats (CBZ = ZIP, CBR = RAR) containing image files
EPUB	The most common e-book file format
Panel Detection	AI feature that identifies individual comic panels on a page
KEPUB	Kobo's enhanced EPUB format
JWT	JSON Web Token — the authentication token used for login sessions
Cron	A scheduling system for running tasks automatically at set times
SMTP	Simple Mail Transfer Protocol — the standard for sending email
Annotation	A highlight, underline, or note you create while reading
Bookmark	A saved position marker in a book
Media Type	A category for your books (e-book, PDF, comic, audiobook, or custom); physical placeholders remain a separate dedicated browsing path under Physical Books
Audit Log	A record of actions taken by users in the application
Reverse Proxy	A server that sits between the internet and BookLore, handling security and routing

29. Document Maintenance Log

Important: This guide must be updated whenever features are added, changed, or removed from BookLore. This HTML file is the source of truth. After any guide change, regenerate the PDF from this HTML and update the README's **Familiarization Guide** section in the same change so the repository docs and maintenance notes stay aligned. Record changes below to track guide accuracy over time.

Date	Version	Change Description
2026-05-18	1.1.100	Recorded the AI panel security remediation: the bundled Pillow dependency now pins to the first non-vulnerable 12.2.0 release, the temporary Dependabot ignore on Pillow major updates was removed, and future 12.x AI-panel security updates can now flow back through the normal unattended maintenance path
2026-05-18	1.1.99	Documented the paged-first browser startup flow so All Books , library, shelf, and Not Shelfed views can render from the first server page without waiting for a full catalog bootstrap, and clarified that topbar search now stays responsive on large libraries by querying lightweight server-backed results
2026-05-13	1.1.98	Reformatted the guide into a darker, more book-like reading presentation for both HTML and PDF output, clarified that users who want regular built-in reader behavior can copy or import the PDF into a library or BookDrop manually, and made the maintenance rule explicit: update this HTML source, regenerate the PDF, and refresh the README guide section together
2026-05-13	1.1.97	Updated the guide for the current dashboard workflow: documented the supported scroller types, per-panel layout controls, and the optional Currently Reading panel plus the More Actions → Currently Reading shortcut that feeds it, and added the Global Preferences theme-configurator workflow for preset or custom primary/surface colors that persist per user
2026-04-22	1.1.96	Clarified that Manage Directories and the directory picker now show imported-state badges not only for exact library paths but also for parent directories that already contain imported subdirectories, and recorded that the Book Details metadata search tab now flexes to the dialog height so footer actions remain reachable without extra viewport scrolling
2026-04-20	1.1.95	Documented ComicVine issue-navigation assist in metadata search: when a ComicVine volume URL is provided, optional issue number or issue-range inputs can now resolve exact issue results directly (for example issue 46 or range 43-171) to preserve issue-title formatting accuracy
2026-04-20	1.1.94	Documented metadata-search URL assist: the search form now accepts provider page URLs (including ComicVine volume and issue links), can auto-seed search text from supported URL slugs, and for supported URL ID formats can resolve a direct provider item fetch instead of relying on broad term matching alone

2026-04-20	1.1.93	Documented metadata-review follow-ups so using Discard from the topbar metadata-progress widget now clears the matching review task/proposals and removes stale notification state immediately, and clarified that metadata search in multi-book editing now includes the same previous/next group navigation flow used in the details tab
2026-04-18	1.1.92	Documented the mobile back-navigation overhaul so Android/iOS system back now closes the topmost open mobile surface first across browsing and reading flows (including book-browser filters, shared book-card and physical-book mobile viewers, topbar popovers, EPUB/CBX reader sidebars and quick overlays, and audiobook mobile panels) before route-level navigation proceeds underneath those UI layers
2026-04-17	1.1.91	Recorded the reverse-engineered cleanup for the repeated mobile title-tap preview regression: the fallback full-window preview behavior for physical assets is now centralized in the shared Book Card component for mobile interaction mode when no parent title-activation handler is wired, which keeps Home/dashboard and browser grid cards consistent with the dedicated Physical Books flow instead of regressing to tooltip-only taps; tests now verify both the external handler path and the shared fallback preview path
2026-04-17	1.1.90	Recorded the final Physical Books mobile preview activation repair for high-resolution phones (including compact landscape phone viewports): title-tap interactivity now uses a dedicated mobile interaction mode based on viewport shape rather than raw width alone, so the full-window asset preview reliably opens with title/subtitle on phone landscape resolutions where previous fixes incorrectly fell back to desktop tooltip behavior; regression coverage now includes compact landscape phone dimensions plus desktop exclusion checks
2026-04-17	1.1.89	Recorded the root-cause repair for the lingering Physical Books mobile title-tap regression: interactive mobile title areas in the shared book card now render through a dedicated branch with no tooltip directive attached at all , so tapping the title no longer shows the small text tooltip overlay and instead goes directly through the mobile viewer activation path; regression coverage was strengthened with a real click-path spec and a template guard that keeps the tooltip directive out of the interactive title branch
2026-04-17	1.1.88	

		Recorded the final Physical Books mobile title-area repair: the shared book-card title tap no longer triggers the small title tooltip overlay on interactive mobile shelves, the tap now goes straight to the full mobile viewer, and the shared card regression coverage now guards both the direct title-activation event and the absence of that redundant mobile title overlay
2026-04-17	1.1.87	Recorded the final Dependabot cleanup for this release cycle: standalone TypeScript 6 bumps are now ignored until the Angular 21 build toolchain in BookLore supports that major range, preventing another unmergeable red PR while the compatible frontend-tooling updates land separately
2026-04-17	1.1.86	Recorded the Dependabot follow-up after the Physical Books repair release: frontend npm updates remain ungrouped by default, but @angular/* packages are now grouped together so Angular peer-locked releases arrive as one coherent PR instead of several individually unmergeable red PRs; the incompatible ngx-extended-pdf-viewer v26 line remains ignored until the PDF reader is migrated deliberately
2026-04-17	1.1.85	Recorded the follow-up repair for the Physical Books mobile experience: the shared card title tap is now correctly wired on that route so the single-card viewer opens and closes from the title area as intended, the page now owns an explicit viewport-height scroll shell so vertical scrolling works reliably on mobile inside the fixed app layout, a dedicated Physical Books regression spec now covers the title-activation wiring and mobile viewer state, and Dependabot now ignores the incompatible ngx-extended-pdf-viewer v26 line until that reader migration is handled intentionally
2026-04-17	1.1.84	Recorded the book-card title-area hotfix after the initial mobile viewer release: the shared card template now binds the interactive title container correctly again so asset titles render normally instead of leaking raw Angular attribute bindings into the visible text, and a rendered DOM regression test now guards that title-area button attributes stay real attributes rather than literal text
2026-04-17	1.1.83	Documented the dependency-hygiene follow-up that removes unused frontend package noise, aligns the sanitizer dependency with the non-vulnerable release already used by the lockfile, and stops grouped npm Dependabot PRs from piling unrelated lockfile changes together; also recorded that the Not Shelves row once again shows its count badge and that Physical Books now scroll

		correctly on mobile while offering a title-tap full-window viewer with swipe navigation between cards
2026-04-17	1.1.82	Documented the media-type sidebar follow-up so managed Media Type rows once again use the same single badge slot as other actionable rows, showing the count normally and swapping that same spot to the 3-dot menu trigger on hover or focus instead of leaving a separate trailing ellipsis button beside the badge
2026-04-17	1.1.81	Documented the dashboard settings follow-up repair so the Add Scroller action and dialog copy now consistently allow up to 20 dashboard scrollers instead of stopping at five, and noted that Media Type sidebar rows once again show a single count badge while keeping their action menu available
2026-04-17	1.1.80	Documented the deeper follow-up regression fix: book-card action menus now anchor to the real inner button element so popup alignment stays stable across the grid, the dedicated Physical Books route once again owns physical-only browsing instead of surfacing a synthetic PHYSICAL media type, and fullscreen library-management dialogs now keep their lower actions reachable on smaller mobile screens by letting the dialog shell own height while the component footers own the safe-area padding
2026-04-17	1.1.79	Recorded the regression hotfix that re-anchors book-card action overlays to their actual trigger buttons, restores Media Type management menus for physical-book views and physical rows assigned to custom media types, and adds safer mobile viewport padding so the lower actions in Library Settings , Manage Directories , and Library Maintenance stay reachable above browser chrome
2026-04-15	1.1.78	Documented the dashboard expansion to 20 panels, the mobile dashboard refresh layout repair, the restored ISBN metadata lookup and duplicate protection for physical-book creation, the multi-row physical shelf view, the new sidecar backup run history list in Settings → Backups , and the broader mobile dialog sizing improvements for library-management workflows
2026-04-15	1.1.77	Recorded the deeper library-dialog handoff repair after reverse engineering the underlying dialog framework: switching between Library Settings , Manage Directories , and Library Maintenance now waits for the old dialog instance to be fully destroyed before opening the next one, which fixes same-dialog workflow links that could still disappear during the close animation window

2026-04-15	1.1.76	Recorded the follow-up repair for the linked Library Settings , Manage Directories , and Library Maintenance dialogs so switching between them now waits for the current dialog to fully close before the next one opens, preventing the workflow buttons from dismissing the current dialog without showing the target view
2026-04-15	1.1.75	Clarified that the linked Library Settings , Manage Directories , and Library Maintenance dialogs now hand off cleanly between each other, documented that Delete from Disk is hidden whenever Allow File Deletion is disabled, and recorded that Remove from Library now stays hidden across later scans and watcher activity while the underlying file remains on disk
2026-04-15	1.1.74	Documented the book-browser filter routing repair so switching between AND , OR , NOT , and 1 no longer reuses a stale prior route context, preventing selector changes in one library from snapping the view back to an earlier Not Shelfed session or falsely showing an empty result set
2026-04-15	1.1.73	Documented the safer browser and series multi-select behavior so bulk selections now resync cleanly between grid and table views, accepted background jobs clear the prior selection instead of leaving hidden books armed, and the browser header explicitly warns when some selected books are outside the current filtered view
2026-04-13	1.1.72	Documented the dedicated Re-order sidebar mode so drag sorting only activates when explicitly toggled on, clarified that headings and sidebar rows can now be reordered directly with mouse or touch while the mode is active, and noted that the normal mobile and desktop sidebar overlay returns to plain navigation behavior when sorting is off
2026-04-13	1.1.71	Corrected the mobile full-screen Manage Directories picker sizing so it no longer causes a slight sideways scroll, clarified that the left and right mobile side-panel grab handles stay visibly present as touch targets instead of appearing only during interaction, and documented that a phone back gesture now closes the mobile book-browser filter sidebar before navigating the underlying page
2026-04-13	1.1.70	Documented the denser mobile Manage Directories picker layout so search and selection controls stay compact while the folder list keeps more vertical space, and clarified that the visible touch grab handles now stay on both the left and right side panels on mobile

2026-04-13	1.1.69	Documented the connected Library Settings/Manage Directories/Library Maintenance workflow, clarified that Reconcile Library now requires an explicit acknowledgement while the maintenance dialog points routine discovery back to Scan for New Files , noted the mobile full-screen directory picker and touch sidebar grab handle improvements, and recorded that Allow File Deletion also protects additional attached files instead of being bypassed there
2026-04-13	1.1.68	Documented that scheduled Library Scan now follows the same additive new-file-only behavior as manual Scan for New Files , and clarified that additive scan routines queue background directory-tagging only for newly imported books while Reconcile Library remains the deliberate whole-library maintenance path
2026-04-12	1.1.67	Fixed the Manage Directories save-note emphasis so the action labels render correctly, clarified that changing directory-tag rules does not silently retag existing books during a settings save, and aligned the guide with the safer future-import-only tagging boundary until an explicit retag tool exists
2026-04-12	1.1.66	Clarified that the Manage Directories list itself now shows imported directories, tightened the save-versus-scan wording, grouped Library Settings , Manage Directories , and Library Maintenance near the bottom of the library menu, and fixed the in-app User Guide PDF delivery path so it opens the guide file instead of falling back into the app shell
2026-04-12	1.1.65	Documented the new Phase 5 per-directory precision flow so Manage Directories now offers a plain Save and an explicit Save & Scan New Directories action, clarified that only newly added directories are scanned, and noted the clearer green Imported badges in the directory picker
2026-04-12	1.1.64	Documented the Phase 4 library editing split so Library Settings and Manage Directories are separate actions, clarified their intended use, and recorded that directory changes now use explicit add/remove directory verbs instead of one overloaded edit/update flow
2026-04-12	1.1.63	Documented the new Library Maintenance boundary for high-impact library actions, moved Reconcile Library behind that dedicated dialog, and clarified that library-wide sidecar import/export/backup tools now live there while Scan for New Files remains the routine safe discovery action

2026-04-12	1.1.62	Documented that Scan for New Files and Reconcile Library now appear directly in library action menus instead of being hidden inside a nested library options group
2026-04-12	1.1.61	Recorded the 3.9.1 hotfix that repaired the new library shelf menu regression tests so the release pipeline can complete successfully without changing the documented library workflow
2026-04-11	1.1.60	Documented the new safe Scan for New Files library action, clarified that the former library re-scan flow is now presented as Reconcile Library , and noted that saving library changes no longer silently triggers a full reconcile
2026-04-11	1.1.59	Reduced the right-edge inset for sidebar filter count badges by half and aligned the badge column with the accordion chevrons so the filter rows track the same visual edge as their section headers
2026-04-11	1.1.58	Documented the consistent right-edge alignment for sidebar filter badges, and noted that the broken grouped Dependabot frontend dependency PR was replaced with a curated compatible dependency refresh on develop instead of merging the failing update set
2026-04-11	1.1.57	Documented the sidebar accordion fix so switching from active tag filters to other filter groups no longer half-opens and snaps shut, and clarified that advanced custom metadata fetch now defaults to Merge Genres off and Manual Review on
2026-04-10	1.1.56	Corrected the Settings return control to use the same icon-only route-return pattern as other route-mode screens, and documented that browser card subtitles now depend on the list API preserving metadata.subtitle so titles can render as Title : Subtitle across cards, previews, and tooltips
2026-04-10	1.1.54	Clarified the follow-up browser display-settings fix so the return arrow is visibly shown as a left-arrow button and subtitle toggles update already-rendered book cards immediately instead of only affecting later refreshes
2026-04-10	1.1.53	Documented the book-browser display-settings return arrow and subtitle toggle, plus clarified that directory browsing now forces filename A-Z display until you clear the scoped folder view or re-click the active library or shelf
2026-04-09	1.1.52	Added the Metadata Review Tag & Next action to append the Metadata Follow-Up Req tag without accepting the current proposal, and clarified that Finish & Close now clears the related

		topbar metadata notification/task state when the review session ends
2026-04-09	1.1.51	Documented the Metadata Review dialog refresh: renamed the proposal screen, moved the copy-missing and copy-all buttons to the bottom action bar, added skip-to-end queueing, added the one-click Copy All, Save & Next shortcut, and clarified that acceptance now waits for the underlying metadata save to finish before the review advances
2026-04-08	1.1.50	Reworked sidebar filter-mode switching so the parent browser now clears the old filter state before activating the new AND/OR/NOT/1 mode, preventing the mode button from showing one state while the book list still filters with the previous mode; added regression tests for parent-owned mode changes and stale-selection suppression
2026-04-08	1.1.49	Hardened filter-mode propagation so the AND/OR/NOT/1 value is normalised (trimmed, lowercased, validated) at every entry point—URL params, persisted user settings, component inputs, and the core filtering function—preventing a mode value that differs by case or whitespace from silently disabling the NOT exclusion logic; added SideBarFilter integration tests exercising the full observable chain
2026-04-08	1.1.48	Fixed Date Added and Folder sidebar filters so they actually filter the book list under every mode (AND, OR, NOT, 1) instead of silently returning no results or doing nothing; added comprehensive regression tests for all four filter modes
2026-04-08	1.1.47	Documented the right-sidebar filter refresh fix so tag and metadata edits repopulate sidebar facets immediately, and clarified that filter highlights no longer stick after deselection when ids change format
2026-04-08	1.1.46	Clarified that the custom metadata age filter uses the last successful metadata fetch time, and documented the paused topbar metadata pill plus its new fetched-versus-remaining task log dialog
2026-04-08	1.1.45	Documented the follow-up metadata-task history fix so completed metadata batches no longer perform unnecessary resume-state lookups while building the task activity list
2026-04-08	1.1.44	Documented the custom metadata fetch target-book selector and the new ability to resume stopped metadata batches instead of rerunning the full selection

2026-04-08	1.1.43	Documented that the metadata-fetch topbar pill now restores from active task state after refreshes and that long provider cooldown waits no longer keep the metadata batch DB transaction open
2026-04-07	1.1.42	Documented that metadata-task cancellation now stays in a cancellation-requested state until the current provider step stops and that stale finished metadata tasks no longer immediately reappear in the progress widget
2026-04-07	1.1.41	Documented the renamed bulk restore-titles action and the metadata-fetch topbar pill now showing a paused resume time when ComicVine throttling temporarily delays a batch
2026-04-07	1.1.40	Documented the bulk metadata action that restores blank titles from each selected book's primary filename without overwriting existing titles
2026-04-07	1.1.39	Documented that metadata wipes now keep a filename-derived title when available and that blank titles can be restored from the primary filename inside the metadata editor
2026-04-07	1.1.38	Documented that large imports now hand directory-based tagging off to a separate visible background task with live progress, time-remaining messaging, and Task Management history
2026-04-07	1.1.37	Documented that the folder explorer panel now keeps root folders and nested folders in alphabetical order while browsing by directory
2026-04-07	1.1.36	Documented the new topbar fullscreen toggle, the light grey sidecar-backup working pill in Metadata Persistence, and the AI batch-scan pill clearing itself shortly after completion
2026-04-07	1.1.35	Documented that physical-book directory sidecars now skip creating a new placeholder during library refresh when the library already contains the matching active book, preventing duplicate entries from sidecar-backed rebuilds
2026-04-06	1.1.34	Documented the cached-route reattachment fix for the book browser so metadata-backed sidebar filters repopulate immediately for sidecar-backed libraries without requiring a browser refresh or a filter-sort toggle
2026-04-06	1.1.33	Documented that library and shelf navigation now refreshes the cached book list so metadata-backed sidebar filters repopulate immediately without a manual browser refresh, even when sidecar-backed metadata is involved

2026-04-06	1.1.32	Documented that the library edit directory picker now labels folders already imported into the current library so additional folders are easier to spot before saving
2026-04-06	1.1.31	Documented the right filter sidebar anchoring fix so the desktop filter panel stays flush to the right edge after the single-scroll sidebar update
2026-04-06	1.1.30	Documented the book-browser filter sidebar scroll fix so the desktop right sidebar now uses one continuous scrollbar instead of nested scroll areas inside long filter groups
2026-04-06	1.1.29	Documented clearer manual sidecar backup failure reporting, including failed write counts and the first filesystem error when BookLore can read books but cannot create sidecar files in the library directory
2026-04-06	1.1.28	Clarified that duplicate review is launched from library menus, removed the book-browser duplicate shortcut, and documented that manual sidecar backup now includes normal digital formats even when books also have non-book attachments
2026-04-06	1.1.27	Documented that manual per-library sidecar backup works in both LOCAL and NETWORK disk modes and clarified that normal EPUB and PDF library backups now resolve book paths correctly instead of reporting zero exported books
2026-04-06	1.1.26	Documented the new manual per-library sidecar backup action in Metadata Persistence, including backups that run even when automatic sidecars are disabled and refresh existing backup sidecars in place
2026-04-06	1.1.25	Documented immediate sidebar filter-mode button selection updates plus the new physical-book directory sidecars that preserve physical placeholders across rebuilds and let sidecar exports include physical books
2026-04-06	1.1.24	Clarified that the duplicate-review dialog now shows stronger active selection states, follows the current theme more closely for its surfaces and comparison cards, and starts the Custom matching preset with all signals cleared
2026-04-06	1.1.23	Documented the saved duplicate-plan snapshot view that exposes queued groups, preferred keeps, and saved scan context before a new scan runs
2026-04-06	1.1.22	

		Documented that duplicate-resolution plans are now saved to the user account so queued keep choices can be restored on a later review pass
2026-04-06	1.1.21	Documented the new manual duplicate-resolution plan flow, including choosing a preferred keep and exporting a non-destructive follow-up list
2026-04-06	1.1.20	Expanded the duplicate-review documentation to cover the new non-destructive inspection actions, including side-by-side candidate comparison plus quick links to book details and supported readers
2026-04-06	1.1.19	Documented the redesigned duplicate-review workflow, including current-view, current-library, and all-library scan scopes plus the new non-destructive review-only behavior
2026-04-06	1.1.18	Documented that changing sidebar filter modes now clears the active sidebar selections first, and clarified the filter-mode tooltips for the compact AND/OR/NOT/1 controls
2026-04-06	1.1.17	Clarified sidebar filter mode behavior with tooltips and documented that AND mode now narrows same-filter options, such as tags, to combinations that still have matching books
2026-04-06	1.1.16	Documented same-directory physical placeholder duplicate prevention and clarified that deleting a digital book's last readable format now removes accidental empty shells instead of leaving a fileless non-physical entry behind
2026-04-05	1.1.15	Documented that metadata editors can now cancel running bulk metadata fetches from the progress widget without needing full task-manager access
2026-04-05	1.1.14	Documented that cancelling a throttled ComicVine bulk metadata fetch now breaks out of the provider wait immediately instead of waiting for the cooldown to finish
2026-04-05	1.1.13	Clarified throttled ComicVine bulk metadata notifications to show an explicit time-left snapshot alongside the reset ETA
2026-04-05	1.1.12	Documented the reduced-request ComicVine top-match path for bulk metadata scans to lower the chance of hitting hourly API limits mid-batch
2026-04-05	1.1.11	Documented explicit wait-state messaging with ETA for throttled bulk metadata scans while the provider cooldown is in effect

2026-04-05	1.1.10	Documented that throttled bulk metadata requests now retry after the provider cooldown and stay visible as active instead of being mislabeled as stalled
2026-04-05	1.1.9	Documented that bulk metadata scans now wait through temporary provider throttling instead of skipping the remainder of the batch immediately
2026-04-05	1.1.8	Documented the more resilient bulk custom metadata scan behavior when a provider's first candidate fails
2026-04-05	1.1.7	Documented the Physical Books HOME view, library-directory-aware physical book creation, and Physical Media Type filtering
2026-04-05	1.1.6	Documented sidebar-driven thumbnail warming for faster library switching and the new WebP thumbnail delivery path for supported browsers
2026-04-05	1.1.5	Documented per-user Media Type and filter sidebar persistence plus filename-first browsing when selecting directories
2026-04-05	1.1.4	Documented filename fallback for untitled book cards and clarified the metadata editor delete-all action placement near fetch controls
2026-04-05	1.1.3	Documented large-library import feedback, persistent sidebar heading visibility, improved Book Details close behavior, and single/bulk metadata deletion actions
2026-04-04	1.1.2	Documented AI totals in Library Statistics and refreshed guide after book browser and shelf-row UI fixes
2026-04-04	1.1.1	Reviewed guide after README badge repair; no feature workflow changes required in user-facing instructions
2026-04-02	1.1	Added directory explorer documentation to interface, browsing, and filtering sections
2026-03-30	1.0	Initial guide created — covers all BookLore 3.0 features

*BookLore 3.0 Familiarization Guide — Maintained as part of the BookLore documentation.
For technical documentation, see the other files in the `docs/` folder. For installation, see `README.md`.*